

MODERN INDIAN HISTORY



MODULE - 21

EDUCATION POLICY
PART 1

EDUCATION POLICY

INTRODUCTION

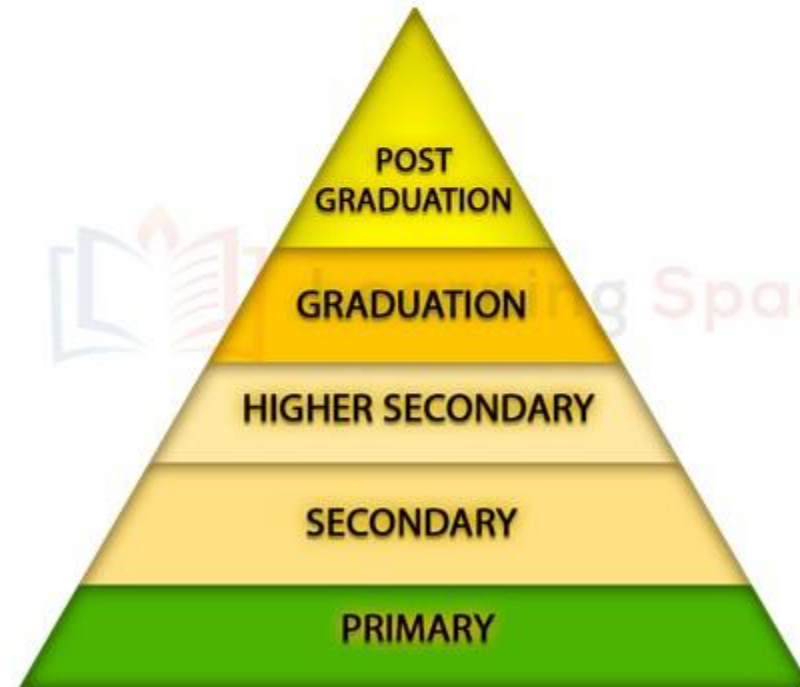
Education is the process of learning, or getting of knowledge, skills, values and habits of essential needs of life.

ANCIENT SYSTEM OF EDUCATION



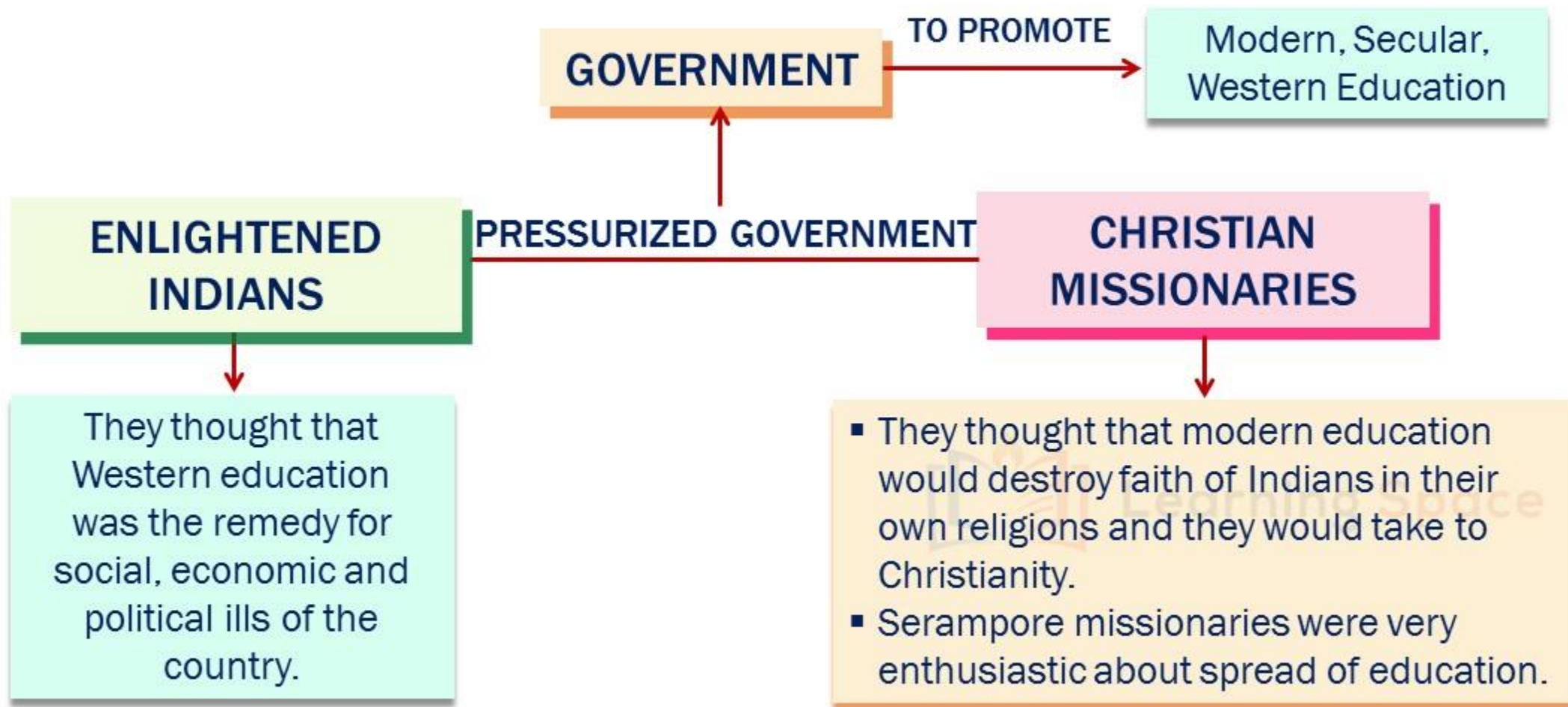
GURUKUL SYSTEM

PRESENT DAY SYSTEM OF EDUCATION



EDUCATION POLICY

STEP TOWARDS MODERN EDUCATION



EDUCATION REFORMS

STEP TOWARDS MODERN EDUCATION

*British wanted to use modern education to **strengthen** the foundations of their **political authority** in India.*

SELF-MOTIVE OF GOVERNMENT

To ensure a cheap supply of educated Indians

- For subordinate posts in administration.

To ensure Business expansion

- Hoped that educated Indians would consume British goods which will help in expanding market for British manufactures in India.

To reconcile Indians

- Hoped that Anglicized Indians would support and favour British thereby further strengthening their roots in India.

Thus there was an emphasis on English medium as the language of administration and of education.

EDUCATION REFORMS

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1765-1858

UNDER THE COMPANY RULE

CHARTER ACT OF 1813

LORD MACAULAY'S MINUTE, 1835

WOOD DISPATCH, 1854

1858- 1947



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SADDLER UNIVERSITY COMMISSION (1917-19)

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HARTOG COMMITTEE (1929)

WARDHA SCHEME OF BASIC EDUCATION, 1937

SERGEANT PLAN, 1944

EDUCATION POLICY

INITIAL EFFORTS

Since East India company was a trading company, their main motive was to maximize profit and fill their coffers so they **took no interest in promotion of education**. However **some minor initiatives** have been taken like

1781

Calcutta Madrasah was established by Warren Hastings for the study of Muslim law and related subjects.

1791

Sanskrit College was established by Jonathan Duncan for study of Hindu law and philosophy.

1800

Fort William College was set up by Wellesley for training of civil servants of Company in languages and customs of Indians.

1813

Charter Act of 1813 directed Company to sanction Rs.1 lakh annually to promote knowledge of modern sciences in the country.

Calcutta Madrasah and the Sanskrit College were designed to provide a regular supply of qualified Indians to help the administration of law in the Company's court.

EDUCATION POLICY

DISSENSION AMONG VARIOUS OPINIONS

Regarding the way of spending the money for education, there were various opinions in terms of:

	OPINION 1	OPINION 2	OPINION 3
AIMS	Preferred Western literature.	Preferred oriental literature	
AGENCIES	Christian Missionaries	Indian themselves	Company should establish educational institutions.
MEDIUM	Education should be given mostly through the medium of English	Western sciences and knowledge should be promoted through Modern Indian language.	Classical language (Sanskrit and Arabic).
METHODS	'Downwards Filtration Theory'. i.e. education should filters down from upper class to masses.	Company should take responsibility for educating masses.	

EDUCATION POLICY

DISSENSION AMONG VARIOUS OPINIONS

GENERAL COMMITTEE OF PUBLIC INSTRUCTION, 1823

In 1823, the Governor-General-in Council appointed a “General Committee of Public Instruction”, which had the responsibility to grant the one lakh of rupees for education.



Earlier, the committee decided to spend major portions from the grant for the **improvement of oriental literature**.



But there was a **change in attitude** of company towards the English education, mainly due to the **missionaries** and the **political influence**.



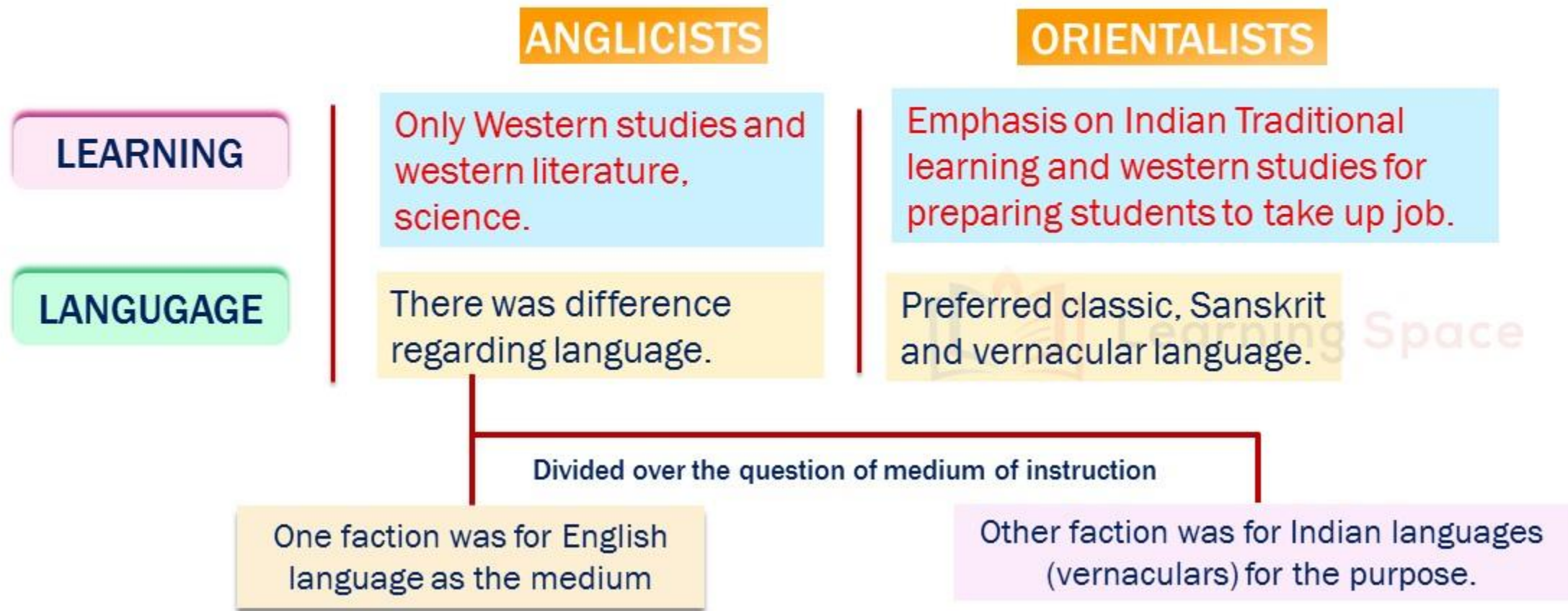
In committee out of ten members-

- five were supporters of **English language or Anglicist** as the medium of instruction and
- rest five were supporters of **oriental or classic language** as a medium of instruction.

This is the famous Anglicist and Classicists controversy.

DISSENSION AMONG TWO SCHOOLS OF THOUGHT

Controversy between Anglicists and Orientalists who had opposite views regarding spending of money on education based on language and learning.



LORD MACAULAY'S MINUTE, 1835

LORD MACAULAY'S MINUTE SETTLED THE ROW IN FAVOR OF ANGLICISTS.

He believed that **European literature** is much advanced. He wrote in the *Minute*-
"A single shelf of a good European library was worth the whole native literature of India and Arabia,"

Because it would enable the **emergence** of a class of people in the Indian society who are **Indian in blood and colour, but English in taste, in opinions, in morals, and in intellect**".

He **stressed on English language as a medium of instruction** through his minute. According to him, English was the best medium of instruction.

As a **president** of General Committee of Public Instruction, Lord Macaulay wrote a minute where he made the conclusion regarding the controversy.



Macaulay anglicized the education in India as a whole **so as to get benefits in their business policy**.

Lord Macaulay to create this class **introduced Downward Filtration Theory**. It means that the education was provided to a small upper echelons, and through them, education was conveyed to the masses.

A 'FILTERED' EDUCATION

EDUCATION POLICY

LORD MACAULAY'S MINUTE, 1835

STEPS TAKEN BY BRITISH GOVERNMENT

Lord William Bentinck passed the resolution of the Macaulay's Minute in 1835.

As per this resolution

Government soon made **English as the medium of instruction.**

All the funds that were allotted for Indian education should be disbursed **only in favour of English language.**

Opened English schools and colleges.

*1835, Lord Macaulay westernized education in India; **English** was made the official language for the government and courts replacing Persian language, and was adopted as the **official medium of instruction.***

EDUCATION POLICY

LORD MACAULAY'S MINUTE, 1835

WHY ENGLISH AND EUROPEAN LEARNING WAS PROPOSED BY MACAULAY?

Lord Macaulay held the view that “Indian learning was inferior to European learning”.

Minute is based on an idea that English education is not just superior in 'science', but would also inculcate superior morals.

Anglicized Indian class would serve as a medium of contact with the masses who were culturally different from the English.

They would also be the agents of change in the Indian society.

EIC never really wanted to invest in education. But English education became important when the lower levels of the bureaucracy had to be staffed.

His opinion was that public mind of India may expand under English education system and it can enhance their capacity for better government.

EDUCATION POLICY

LORD MACAULAY'S MINUTE, 1835

REACTION TO MACAULAY MINUTE

POSITIVE REACTION

Some **people of higher classes** in India and the **EIC** appreciated **Macaulay** as the torch bearer in the path of progress.

Supported by social reformer as English education was seen as a tool to eradicate social evils like superstition and counter orthodoxy in the society.

Supported by educated class as it will help Indians to get jobs and also to inculcate scientific and rational thought

NEGATIVE REACTION

Macaulay was **blamed for taking quick decision** to promote the English language.

Macaulay was also **blamed by some Indians** for his severe **condemnation of oriental literature and religion**.

Muslims were hostile to this education policy. Some Muslims who were opposed to English education did not get Government posts and started socially diverging from the Hindus.

The concept of filtration did not work because the educated Zamindar did not go back and educate his tenants.

EDUCATION POLICY

LORD MACAULAY'S MINUTE, 1835

NEGATIVE FALL OUTS OF DOWNWARD FILTRATION THEORY

Failed severely in imparting mass education. **Elite never wanted to share their benefits with common man.**

Gap between educated and uneducated widened which **ultimately led to stratification of society**

Muslims who opposed English education system did not get Government posts and started socially diverging from the Hindus which later **became root cause of communal tension**

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WOOD'S DESPATCH (1854)

BACKGROUND

WHY WOOD DISPATCH WAS BROUGHT?

Due to failure Macaulay's downward filtration theory in imparting mass education , **education in India had come to suffer numerous problems.**



SIR CHARLES WOOD

- So when time of renewal came in 1853 (1813 -1lakh, 1833- 10lakh allotted), directors of company decided **to lay down a definite policy for education in India.**
- Therefore, it became necessary to make a comprehensive survey of the entire field of education.

- Sir Charles Wood was the president of the Board of Control issued the declaration in 1854, known as "Wood's Despatch".
- On the basis of the recommendations of the Wood's Despatch, new educational policies were formed.

EDUCATION POLICY

WOOD'S DESPATCH (1854)

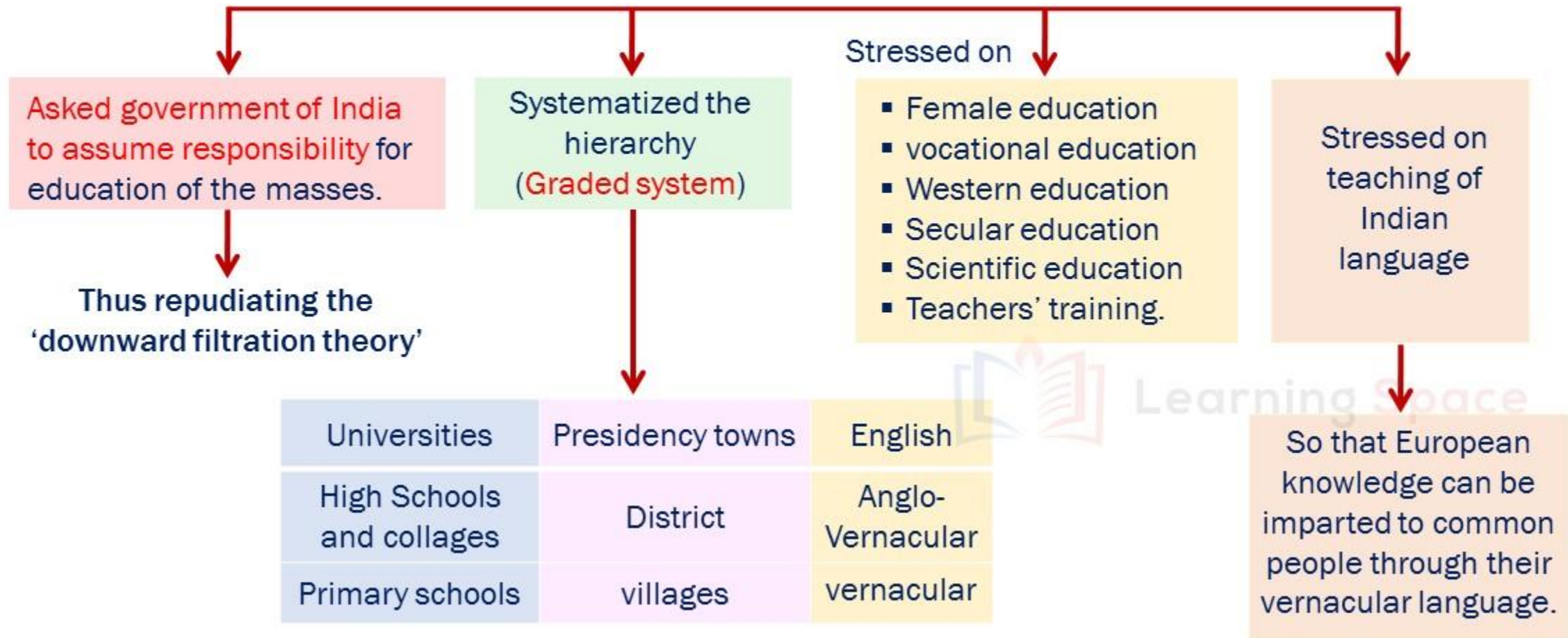
MAGNA CARTA OF INDIAN EDUCATION



EDUCATION POLICY

WOOD'S DESPATCH (1854)

“MAGNA CARTA OF INDIAN EDUCATION”



This document was the first comprehensive plan for the spread of education in India.

EDUCATION POLICY

WOOD'S DESPATCH (1854)

MAGNA CARTA OF INDIAN EDUCATION?

POSITIVE ASPECT



Creation of a Department of Public Instruction i.e. Department of education

System of grants-in-aid to encourage private enterprise.

Despatch encouraged higher education by recommending the establishment of universities in Calcutta, Bombay and Madras.

It presented a comprehensive scheme of education embracing primary, secondary and higher education.

Importance of establishing teacher training institutes.

The principle of Downward Filtration Theory was discarded and it encouraged the promotion of mass education; it recommended the establishment of indigenous schools.

Language teaching was encouraged as a result, regional languages and classical languages were taught in the schools.

Emphasized on necessity of vocational education and recommended scholarships for the poor

EDUCATION POLICY

WOOD'S DESPATCH (1854)

CRITICAL EVALUATION



NEGATIVE ASPECT



Wood's Despatch could not remove the imbalance in Indian education system. The rich people sent their children to English medium schools, and the government gradually stopped financial aid to the indigenous schools and so the existence of these schools became jeopardised.

EDUCATION POLICY

In 1857, universities at Calcutta, Bombay and Madras were set up and later, departments of education were set up in all provinces.

ENGINEERING INSTITUTE, Roorkee (1847)

AGRICULTURE INSTITUTE, Pusa (1847)

BETHUNE SCHOOL (1849)

UNIVERSITY OF CALCUTTA (1857)

(1857) BOMBAY UNIVERSITY

- Bethune School founded by J.E.D. Bethune at Calcutta.
- Bethune was the president of the Council of Education.
- Mostly due to Bethune's efforts, girls' schools were set up.

MADRAS UNIVERSITY (1857)

After the Wood's Despatch, India saw rapid westernization of education, with educational institutions run by European headmasters, principals and Missionary enterprises. Gradually, private Indian effort appeared in the field.

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